

THINKING TOOL 2: SIX THINKING HATS

WHAT IS PARALLEL THINKING?

That saying two heads is better than one may ring true when you're trying to solve a problem, but imagine the problem solving power with six heads or in this case hats. Parallel thinking allows you to approach a problem with six different perspectives.

Select each of the colored hats to find out which perspective is engaged when someone is assigned the hat.



- **White Hat (The Data Analyst):** Focuses on neutral, objective facts and figures, identifying what information is known and what is missing.



See the slide notes for all hat descriptions

Take a quick look at an example that illustrates each of the thinking hats. Select the image to see a larger version.



Let's Think Happy!

The 6 Magical Thinking Hats

MEET THE THINKING HATS!

THE WHITE HAT: THE FACT-FINDER

Focuses on data, figures, and information that is known or needed.

Use it for Research:
Check the grading rubric and due dates before starting a big essay.



THE RED HAT: THE HEART

Represents feelings, hunches, and intuition without needing to explain them.

Use it for Honesty:
Admitting you feel "vibes" of anxiety about a group presentation.



THE BLACK HAT: THE SAFETY CHECK

Signifies caution and critical thinking to identify why something might not work.

Use it for Planning:
Identifying that a club meeting time might conflict with everyone's sports practice.



THE YELLOW HAT: THE SUNSHINE

Symbolizes brightness and optimism, looking for the value and benefits of an idea.

Use it for Motivation:
Seeing how a difficult volunteer project will look amazing on your college application.



THE GREEN HAT: THE CREATOR

Focuses on creativity, possibilities, new ideas, and different ways of doing things.

Use it for Innovation:
Brainstorming a unique viral theme for the school's winter formal dance.



THE BLUE HAT: THE LEADER

The control mechanism used to manage the thinking process and set the agenda.

Use it for Focus:
Keeping your group project team on task so you finish before the bell rings.



MORE HATS FOR BIG IDEAS!



PARALLEL THINKING AND THE 5 GENERALS IN DR. STONE

In Dr. Stone, the Five Wise Generals (Senku, Chrome, Ryusui, Gen, and Ukyo) form the core decision-making body of the Kingdom of Science. While they don't explicitly name Edward de Bono's 6 Thinking Hats, their collaborative dynamic is a perfect masterclass in how Parallel Thinking functions in a high-stakes environment. Rather than arguing against each other, they unconsciously rotate through the hats to solve complex problems, build timelines, and mitigate risks.

In this depiction, Kohaku (also known as the lioness) is added as the red-hat thinker who focuses on matters of the heart and emotion. Select each character to learn why they wear their hat.



Objective Data (Senku)} → Lateral Ideation (Gen)} →
{Value Design (Ryusui)} → {Safety Review (Ukyo)} →
{Process Management (Chrome)} → {Kinetic Execution
(Kohaku)}



By dividing these roles cleanly, the Kingdom of Science functions like a single, highly optimized brain trust, turning impossible tasks into manageable, structured realities.

SELECT EACH DOCTOR STONE CHARACTER TO UNDERSTAND WHY THEY WEAR THE HAT

Senku Ishigami - White Hat Thinker

The White Hat is entirely objective, dealing strictly with hard facts, figures, historical data, and verifiable information. It contains no room for emotional bias, speculation, or wishful thinking.

Senku is the absolute embodiment of the White Hat. Faced with a world frozen in stone for 3,700 years, he does not panic or mourn; instead, he counts the seconds (\$116,427,065,921\$ seconds, to be exact) to keep an accurate temporal baseline.

- Empirical Thinking: When diagnosing petrification, Senku isolates the chemical reaction of nitric acid (HNO_3) and alcohol ($\text{C}_2\text{H}_5\text{OH}$) as the solvent, approaching the problem with pure biochemical calculations.
- Neutrality: He views everything through a lens of natural law. Even when dealing with dangerous enemies, his assessments of their physical capabilities and tactical threats are calculated mathematically, devoid of personal resentment.



Slide notes contain each of the hat alignment.

LET'S SEE OUR GENERALS IN ACTION

Let's listen to a conversation where the generals decide how to plan to revive a workforce for building Senku's rocket to the moon..



Listen now



Go to this link for the script:

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1TL7rWm0zLI60feSSIXP0tBIk0gz0xJzikIBKTFGkuMk/edit?usp=sharing>

NOW YOU TRY IT



Start the quiz

Based on what you've learned about Parallel Thinking and the 6 Thinking Hats, take a quiz that checks on the skills used by each of the Dr. Stone Generals.



Link to Quiz Question:

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1vx4M-900pJFUTOVgdLh_7XlWJy8cHASNYu1tZNAAhyc/edit?usp=sharing